

HEAPSTEEP

Corporate Travel & Expense Policy

Version 3.2 | Effective 01 June 2025

Issued by:	HR & Finance Department
Document Owner:	Chief Financial Officer
Applies to:	All Full-time, Part-time & Contract Employees
Policy Number:	HRP-2025-007
Revision:	3.2

1. Purpose & Scope

This Travel & Expense Policy establishes guidelines for all Heapsteep employees who travel on behalf of the company. It ensures that business travel is conducted safely, cost-effectively, and in compliance with applicable laws and regulations. All employees, contractors, and third parties travelling at Heapsteep's expense are expected to adhere to these guidelines.

The policy covers international and domestic travel including air, rail, ground transportation, hotel accommodation, meals, and incidental expenses.

2. Approval & Booking Process

All business travel must be pre-approved by the employee's direct manager and, for trips exceeding USD 5,000 in total cost, by the department head. Bookings must be made through Heapsteep's designated travel management platform (TravelDesk) at least **7 business days** in advance for domestic trips and **14 business days** for international trips.

Trip Cost Threshold	Approval Required
Up to USD 2,000	Direct Manager
USD 2,001 – 5,000	Direct Manager + Finance
USD 5,001 – 15,000	Department Head + CFO
Above USD 15,000	CEO Approval Required

3. Air Travel

Employees are expected to book the most economical fare available. Class of travel is determined by flight duration and employee grade.

Flight Duration	Staff / Associate	Manager / Sr. Manager	Director & Above
Under 4 hours	Economy	Economy	Economy
4 – 7 hours	Economy	Economy Plus	Business
7 – 10 hours	Economy	Economy Plus	Business
Above 10 hours	Economy Plus	Business	Business

** Upgrades using personal miles/points are permitted but will not be reimbursed. First-class travel is not permitted under any circumstances.*

4. Hotel Accommodation

The table below lists maximum nightly hotel rates (room + tax, single occupancy) per destination. Rates reflect current market conditions and are reviewed annually.

Destination	City / Region	Max Rate (USD/night)	Preferred Hotel Tier
Paris, France	Île-de-France	USD 280	4-star / Boutique
New York, USA	Manhattan & Midtown	USD 320	4-star Business

Destination	City / Region	Max Rate (USD/night)	Preferred Hotel Tier
London, UK	City / West End	USD 300	4-star Business
Tokyo, Japan	Shinjuku / Marunouchi	USD 240	4-star Business
Singapore	CBD / Marina Bay	USD 220	4-star Business
Dubai, UAE	DIFC / Downtown	USD 200	4-star / Executive
San Francisco, USA	SoMa / Financial Dist.	USD 290	4-star Business
Sydney, Australia	CBD / Darling Harbour	USD 230	4-star Business
Frankfurt, Germany	City Centre	USD 210	4-star Business
Mumbai, India	BKC / Nariman Point	USD 160	5-star (local)
Bengaluru, India	Whitefield / MG Road	USD 130	5-star (local)
Toronto, Canada	Downtown / Financial	USD 220	4-star Business
Amsterdam, Neth.	City Centre / Zuidas	USD 240	4-star Business
Other Cities	Tier-1 International	USD 180	3–4-star Business
Other Cities	Tier-2 / Domestic India	USD 90	3-star / Business

Exceptions above the limit require Finance approval 48 hours prior to booking. Employees must book using the corporate card. Personal loyalty points may be earned but cannot be exchanged for cash reimbursement.

5. Per Diem & Meal Allowances

Per diem covers meals and incidental expenses (tips, laundry, portage). Receipts are **not** required for per diem claims, but actual expenses must not be submitted separately when per diem is claimed.

Destination	Breakfast (USD)	Lunch (USD)	Dinner (USD)	Incidentals (USD)	Daily Total (USD)
Paris, France	20	35	60	25	140
New York, USA	22	40	70	30	162
London, UK	20	35	65	25	145
Tokyo, Japan	18	30	55	20	123
Singapore	15	28	50	20	113
Dubai, UAE	18	32	55	20	125
San Francisco, USA	22	38	68	28	156
Sydney, Australia	18	32	58	22	130
Frankfurt, Germany	18	30	52	20	120
Mumbai, India	8	15	25	10	58
Bengaluru, India	7	13	22	8	50
Toronto, Canada	18	30	55	20	123
Amsterdam, Neth.	18	32	56	22	128
Other Intl. Cities	15	25	45	15	100
Domestic India	6	12	20	8	46

For partial travel days: 25% of per diem if travelling less than 4 hours, 75% if between 4–12 hours, and 100% for days exceeding 12 hours. Alcohol is not reimbursable under any meal category.

6. Ground Transportation

Mode	Policy
Taxi / Rideshare	Permitted for airport transfers and client meetings. Receipt required above USD 25.
Rental Car	Economy class only. Manager approval required. CDW insurance must be purchased.
Public Transit	Preferred where safe and practical. Business class rail permitted for trips > 2 hrs.
Personal Vehicle	Reimbursed at prevailing IRS/HMRC mileage rate. Prior approval required.
Chauffeur/Limo	Not permitted unless approved by CFO for VIP client engagements.

7. Communication & Technology

International roaming charges are reimbursable up to **USD 15/day**. Employees are encouraged to use the company VPN and local SIM cards or eSIM for extended trips. Wi-Fi charges at hotels are fully reimbursable. Minibar, pay-per-view, and in-room entertainment are **not** reimbursable.

8. Expense Reporting & Reimbursement

All expense reports must be submitted within **10 business days** of trip completion via the Heapsteep Expense Portal (expenses.heapsteep.com). Late submissions require manager justification. Reimbursement is processed with the next payroll cycle (typically within 15 business days).

Expense Type	Receipt Required	Reimbursement Currency	Processing Time
Airfare	Yes (e-ticket)	As incurred (USD equiv.)	Next payroll
Hotel	Yes (itemised)	As incurred (USD equiv.)	Next payroll
Meals (above per diem)	Yes	As incurred	Next payroll
Ground Transport	Yes (> USD 25)	As incurred	Next payroll
Per Diem	No	USD (fixed rate)	Next payroll
Visa / Entry Fees	Yes	As incurred	Next payroll
Travel Insurance	Yes	As incurred	Next payroll

9. Travel Safety & Insurance

Heapsteep provides comprehensive corporate travel insurance for all pre-approved business travel, covering: medical emergencies (up to USD 500,000), trip cancellation (up to USD 10,000), lost baggage (up to USD 2,500), and personal accident cover (up to USD 250,000). Employees must register international trips in TravelDesk to activate insurance coverage.

Travel to countries with a **Level 3 or Level 4 advisory** (as issued by the relevant government authority) requires written approval from the CEO and CHRO. All employees must complete the Travel Safety Briefing Module in the LMS before travelling to high-risk destinations.

10. Policy Violations & Non-Compliance

Expenses submitted outside policy limits without prior approval will not be reimbursed. Repeated violations will be escalated to HR and may result in disciplinary action. Fraudulent expense claims will result in immediate termination and potential legal action.

11. Policy Review & Contact

This policy is reviewed annually by the Finance and HR departments. Questions or exception requests should be directed to travel@heapsteep.com. The latest version of this policy is available on the Heapsteep Intranet.

Employee Acknowledgement

By undertaking business travel on behalf of Heapsteep, I confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with this Travel & Expense Policy.

Employee Name:

Date:

Signature:

Employee ID: